

COMPLETE CHESS LEARNING LIBRARY

The Complete King's Indian Attack

White-side plans against French, Sicilian, Caro-Kann, and flexible setups

COURSE BOOK

50 focused chapters - model positions - decision rules - retrieval practice

Designed to change what you notice, calculate, remember, and do at the board.

How to Use This Course

ONE CHAPTER, FOUR PASSES

1. Read the position without moving pieces. 2. State your plan and the opponent's counterplay. 3. Study the decision rules. 4. Close the book and reconstruct the position from memory.

RETRIEVAL SCHEDULE

Review the chapter the next day, one week later, and after a game that reaches a similar structure. Retrieval is more valuable than rereading.

BOARD ROUTINE

Opponent's threat - forcing moves - loose pieces - worst piece - central break - best reply - choose and stop.

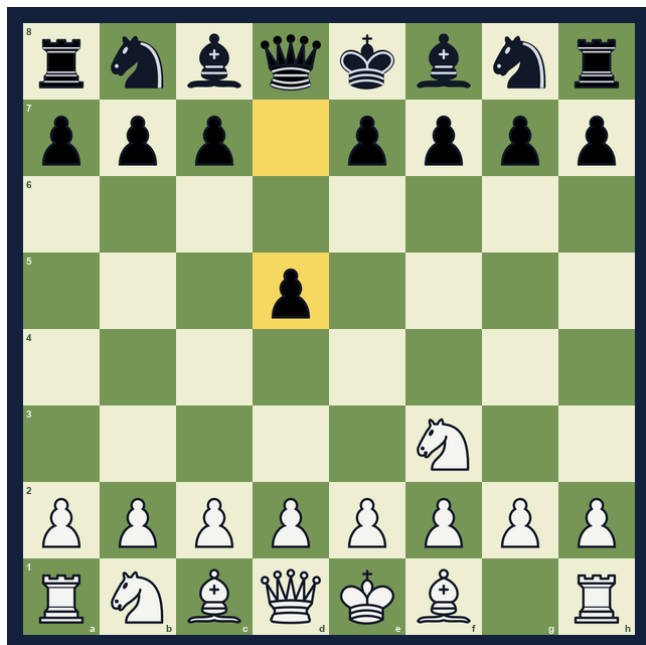
The course book explains each model position. The separate workbook forces recall, prediction, and self-scoring. Use the book first, then attempt the matching workbook page without looking back.

Engine evaluations are intentionally not the lesson. The aim is to store human decision rules that remain useful when the exact move order changes.

Course Map

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01. Core KIA Blueprint - Stage 1



KIA FOUNDATION

READ THE POSITION

White begins with flexible development and has not committed the center.

PRIMARY PLAN

Complete development, read Black's center, then choose e5, c3-d4, or queenside play.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black wants central space with ...d5 and ...c5 and may expand before White's attack begins.

REFERENCE LINE 1. Nf3 d5

MEMORY RULE

The KIA is a starting structure; the center chooses the actual plan.

01. Decision Framework

Core KIA Blueprint - Stage 1

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Play e5 only when it gains useful space and Black cannot answer by opening the center favorably.
PIECE JOB	Re1, Nbd2, Nf1, and Bg2 coordinate around e4 and the future central break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Do not confuse reaching the setup with obtaining an attack; Black may already threaten ...d4.
TRADE FILTER	Keep the g2-bishop when its long diagonal supports the king and central breaks; trade it for a concrete gain.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Forecast which structure, majority, target, or superior piece remains after simplification.
CLOCK RULE	Use quick setup moves, then pause when either side creates central pawn contact.

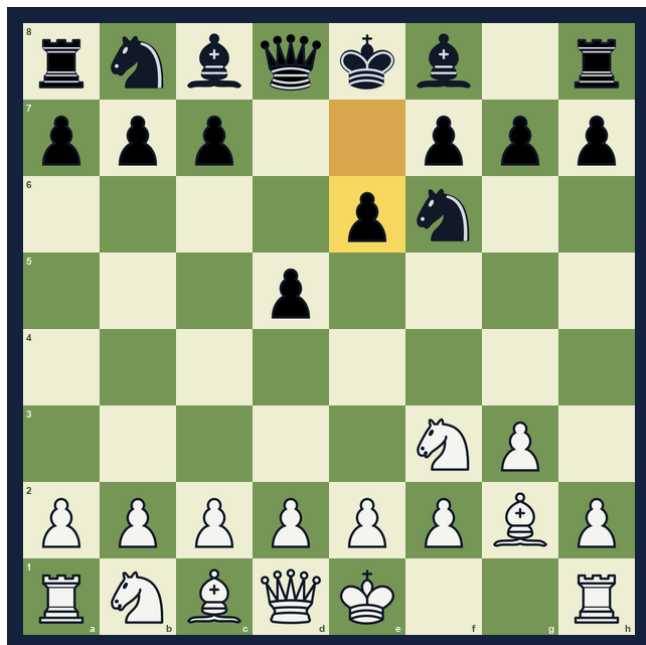
ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: The KIA is a starting structure; the center chooses the actual plan.

02. Core KIA Blueprint - Stage 2



KIA FOUNDATION

READ THE POSITION

The kingside fianchetto is established while the central pawns remain flexible.

PRIMARY PLAN

Complete development, read Black's center, then choose e5, c3-d4, or queenside play.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black wants central space with ...d5 and ...c5 and may expand before White's attack begins.

REFERENCE LINE

1. Nf3 d5 2. g3 Nf6 3. Bg2 e6

MEMORY RULE

The KIA is a starting structure; the center chooses the actual plan.

02. Decision Framework

Core KIA Blueprint - Stage 2

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Play e5 only when it gains useful space and Black cannot answer by opening the center favorably.
PIECE JOB	Re1, Nbd2, Nf1, and Bg2 coordinate around e4 and the future central break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Do not confuse reaching the setup with obtaining an attack; Black may already threaten ...d4.
TRADE FILTER	Keep the g2-bishop when its long diagonal supports the king and central breaks; trade it for a concrete gain.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Forecast which structure, majority, target, or superior piece remains after simplification.
CLOCK RULE	Use quick setup moves, then pause when either side creates central pawn contact.

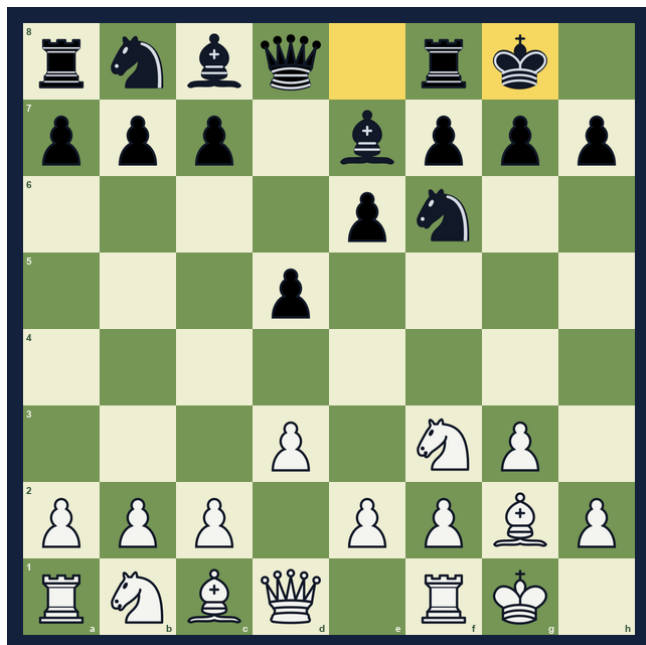
ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: The KIA is a starting structure; the center chooses the actual plan.

03. Core KIA Blueprint - Stage 3



KIA FOUNDATION

READ THE POSITION

White is castled and has built the quiet foundation of the attack.

PRIMARY PLAN

Complete development, read Black's center, then choose e5, c3-d4, or queenside play.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black wants central space with ...d5 and ...c5 and may expand before White's attack begins.

REFERENCE LINE

1. Nf3 d5 2. g3 Nf6 3. Bg2 e6 4. O-O Be7 5. d3 O-O

MEMORY RULE

The KIA is a starting structure; the center chooses the actual plan.

03. Decision Framework

Core KIA Blueprint - Stage 3

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Play e5 only when it gains useful space and Black cannot answer by opening the center favorably.
PIECE JOB	Re1, Nbd2, Nf1, and Bg2 coordinate around e4 and the future central break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Do not confuse reaching the setup with obtaining an attack; Black may already threaten ...d4.
TRADE FILTER	Keep the g2-bishop when its long diagonal supports the king and central breaks; trade it for a concrete gain.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Forecast which structure, majority, target, or superior piece remains after simplification.
CLOCK RULE	Use quick setup moves, then pause when either side creates central pawn contact.

ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: The KIA is a starting structure; the center chooses the actual plan.

04. Core KIA Blueprint - Stage 4



KIA FOUNDATION

READ THE POSITION

White has added e4 while Black challenges the center with ...c5.

PRIMARY PLAN

Complete development, read Black's center, then choose e5, c3-d4, or queenside play.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black wants central space with ...d5 and ...c5 and may expand before White's attack begins.

REFERENCE LINE

1. Nf3 d5 2. g3 Nf6 3. Bg2 e6 4. O-O Be7 5. d3 O-O 6. Nbd2 c5 7. e4 Nc6

MEMORY RULE

The KIA is a starting structure; the center chooses the actual plan.

04. Decision Framework

Core KIA Blueprint - Stage 4

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Play e5 only when it gains useful space and Black cannot answer by opening the center favorably.
PIECE JOB	Re1, Nbd2, Nf1, and Bg2 coordinate around e4 and the future central break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Do not confuse reaching the setup with obtaining an attack; Black may already threaten ...d4.
TRADE FILTER	Keep the g2-bishop when its long diagonal supports the king and central breaks; trade it for a concrete gain.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Forecast which structure, majority, target, or superior piece remains after simplification.
CLOCK RULE	Use quick setup moves, then pause when either side creates central pawn contact.

ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: The KIA is a starting structure; the center chooses the actual plan.

05. Core KIA Blueprint - Stage 5



KIA FOUNDATION

READ THE POSITION

Re1 supports central expansion, but the middlegame plan still depends on Black's center.

PRIMARY PLAN

Complete development, read Black's center, then choose e5, c3-d4, or queenside play.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black wants central space with ...d5 and ...c5 and may expand before White's attack begins.

REFERENCE LINE

1. Nf3 d5 2. g3 Nf6 3. Bg2 e6 4. O-O Be7 5. d3 O-O 6. Nbd2 c5 7. e4 Nc6 8. Re1 b6

MEMORY RULE

The KIA is a starting structure; the center chooses the actual plan.

05. Decision Framework

Core KIA Blueprint - Stage 5

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Play e5 only when it gains useful space and Black cannot answer by opening the center favorably.
PIECE JOB	Re1, Nbd2, Nf1, and Bg2 coordinate around e4 and the future central break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Do not confuse reaching the setup with obtaining an attack; Black may already threaten ...d4.
TRADE FILTER	Keep the g2-bishop when its long diagonal supports the king and central breaks; trade it for a concrete gain.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Forecast which structure, majority, target, or superior piece remains after simplification.
CLOCK RULE	Use quick setup moves, then pause when either side creates central pawn contact.

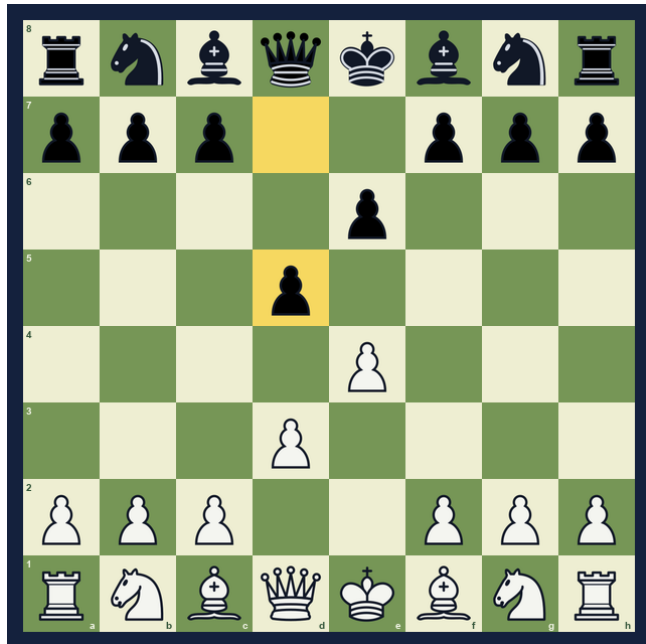
ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: The KIA is a starting structure; the center chooses the actual plan.

06. KIA against the French - Stage 1



KIA VS FRENCH

READ THE POSITION

White has chosen a KIA move order instead of occupying d4 immediately.

PRIMARY PLAN

After a justified e5, build kingside pressure while watching Black's queenside and d4 play.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black wants ...c5, ...Nc6, ...b6, and sometimes ...f6 to attack White's pawn chain.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e6 2. d3 d5

MEMORY RULE

Against the French center, close only when the resulting kingside plan is real.

06. Decision Framework

KIA against the French - Stage 1

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	The e5 advance gains direction only when White can support it and meet ...f6 or ...d4.
PIECE JOB	Nbd2-f1-h2 or e3, Re1, and Bg2 are the recurring pieces behind the attack.
TACTICAL WARNING	Before attacking the king, calculate Black's ...f6 break and any central sacrifice on e5.
TRADE FILTER	Preserve attacking pieces in a closed center; welcome exchanges that remove Black's best blockader.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Forecast which structure, majority, target, or superior piece remains after simplification.
CLOCK RULE	Calculate longer at e5, ...f6, or ...d4; use pattern recognition for routine maneuvering.

ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Against the French center, close only when the resulting kingside plan is real.

07. KIA against the French - Stage 2



KIA VS FRENCH

READ THE POSITION

Both knights are developed behind the compact e4-d3 center.

PRIMARY PLAN

After a justified e5, build kingside pressure while watching Black's queenside and d4 play.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black wants ...c5, ...Nc6, ...b6, and sometimes ...f6 to attack White's pawn chain.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e6 2. d3 d5 3. Nd2 Nf6 4. Ngf3 Be7

MEMORY RULE

Against the French center, close only when the resulting kingside plan is real.

07. Decision Framework

KIA against the French - Stage 2

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	The e5 advance gains direction only when White can support it and meet ...f6 or ...d4.
PIECE JOB	Nbd2-f1-h2 or e3, Re1, and Bg2 are the recurring pieces behind the attack.
TACTICAL WARNING	Before attacking the king, calculate Black's ...f6 break and any central sacrifice on e5.
TRADE FILTER	Preserve attacking pieces in a closed center; welcome exchanges that remove Black's best blockader.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Forecast which structure, majority, target, or superior piece remains after simplification.
CLOCK RULE	Calculate longer at e5, ...f6, or ...d4; use pattern recognition for routine maneuvering.

ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Against the French center, close only when the resulting kingside plan is real.

08. KIA against the French - Stage 3



KIA VS FRENCH

READ THE POSITION

Black has challenged White with the thematic ...c5 break.

PRIMARY PLAN

After a justified e5, build kingside pressure while watching Black's queenside and d4 play.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black wants ...c5, ...Nc6, ...b6, and sometimes ...f6 to attack White's pawn chain.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e6 2. d3 d5 3. Nd2 Nf6 4. Ngf3 Be7 5. g3 O-O 6. Bg2 c5

MEMORY RULE

Against the French center, close only when the resulting kingside plan is real.

08. Decision Framework

KIA against the French - Stage 3

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	The e5 advance gains direction only when White can support it and meet ...f6 or ...d4.
PIECE JOB	Nbd2-f1-h2 or e3, Re1, and Bg2 are the recurring pieces behind the attack.
TACTICAL WARNING	Before attacking the king, calculate Black's ...f6 break and any central sacrifice on e5.
TRADE FILTER	Preserve attacking pieces in a closed center; welcome exchanges that remove Black's best blockader.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Forecast which structure, majority, target, or superior piece remains after simplification.
CLOCK RULE	Calculate longer at e5, ...f6, or ...d4; use pattern recognition for routine maneuvering.

ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Against the French center, close only when the resulting kingside plan is real.

09. KIA against the French - Stage 4



KIA VS FRENCH

READ THE POSITION

Both sides are developed and White is preparing to decide the center.

PRIMARY PLAN

After a justified e5, build kingside pressure while watching Black's queenside and d4 play.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black wants ...c5, ...Nc6, ...b6, and sometimes ...f6 to attack White's pawn chain.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e6 2. d3 d5 3. Nd2 Nf6 4. Ngf3 Be7 5. g3 O-O 6. Bg2 c5 7. O-O Nc6 8. Re1 b6

MEMORY RULE

Against the French center, close only when the resulting kingside plan is real.

09. Decision Framework

KIA against the French - Stage 4

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	The e5 advance gains direction only when White can support it and meet ...f6 or ...d4.
PIECE JOB	Nbd2-f1-h2 or e3, Re1, and Bg2 are the recurring pieces behind the attack.
TACTICAL WARNING	Before attacking the king, calculate Black's ...f6 break and any central sacrifice on e5.
TRADE FILTER	Preserve attacking pieces in a closed center; welcome exchanges that remove Black's best blockader.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Forecast which structure, majority, target, or superior piece remains after simplification.
CLOCK RULE	Calculate longer at e5, ...f6, or ...d4; use pattern recognition for routine maneuvering.

ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Against the French center, close only when the resulting kingside plan is real.

10. KIA against the French - Stage 5



KIA VS FRENCH

READ THE POSITION

White has closed with e5 and begun the familiar Nf1 maneuver.

PRIMARY PLAN

After a justified e5, build kingside pressure while watching Black's queenside and d4 play.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black wants ...c5, ...Nc6, ...b6, and sometimes ...f6 to attack White's pawn chain.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e6 2. d3 d5 3. Nd2 Nf6 4. Ngf3 Be7 5. g3 O-O 6. Bg2 c5 7. O-O Nc6 8. Re1 b6 9. e5 Nd7 10. Nf1

MEMORY RULE

Against the French center, close only when the resulting kingside plan is real.

10. Decision Framework

KIA against the French - Stage 5

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	The e5 advance gains direction only when White can support it and meet ...f6 or ...d4.
PIECE JOB	Nbd2-f1-h2 or e3, Re1, and Bg2 are the recurring pieces behind the attack.
TACTICAL WARNING	Before attacking the king, calculate Black's ...f6 break and any central sacrifice on e5.
TRADE FILTER	Preserve attacking pieces in a closed center; welcome exchanges that remove Black's best blockader.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Forecast which structure, majority, target, or superior piece remains after simplification.
CLOCK RULE	Calculate longer at e5, ...f6, or ...d4; use pattern recognition for routine maneuvering.

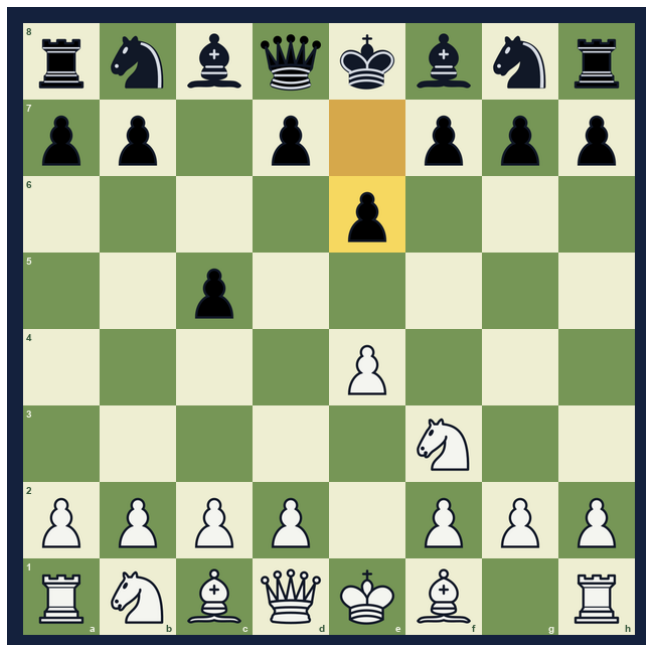
ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Against the French center, close only when the resulting kingside plan is real.

11. KIA against the Sicilian - Stage 1



KIA VS SICILIAN

READ THE POSITION

White has avoided the Open Sicilian and kept a compact center.

PRIMARY PLAN

Use e5, c3-d4, or queenside restraint according to Black's ...d6, ...e6, and ...g6 formation.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black wants ...d5 or ...d6 followed by central pressure and active queenside play.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 e6

MEMORY RULE

Against the Sicilian, the KIA is flexible counterplay-not an automatic kingside attack.

11. Decision Framework

KIA against the Sicilian - Stage 1

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	The e5 break must be calculated because Black may answer with ...d6 and central exchanges.
PIECE JOB	Re1 and Bg2 support e5, while c3 can prepare a later d4 challenge.
TACTICAL WARNING	Watch ...d5 tactics and attacks on the e4 pawn before beginning a kingside maneuver.
TRADE FILTER	Trade centrally when it reduces Black's activity or gives White useful files, not merely to avoid tension.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Forecast which structure, majority, target, or superior piece remains after simplification.
CLOCK RULE	Pause at Black's ...d5 or White's e5; otherwise develop without spending several minutes.

ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Against the Sicilian, the KIA is flexible counterplay-not an automatic kingside attack.

12. KIA against the Sicilian - Stage 2



KIA VS SICILIAN

READ THE POSITION

Both sides are building flexible fianchetto structures around a Sicilian center.

PRIMARY PLAN

Use e5, c3-d4, or queenside restraint according to Black's ...d6, ...e6, and ...g6 formation.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black wants ...d5 or ...d6 followed by central pressure and active queenside play.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 e6 3. d3 Nc6 4. g3 g6

MEMORY RULE

Against the Sicilian, the KIA is flexible counterplay-not an automatic kingside attack.

12. Decision Framework

KIA against the Sicilian - Stage 2

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	The e5 break must be calculated because Black may answer with ...d6 and central exchanges.
PIECE JOB	Re1 and Bg2 support e5, while c3 can prepare a later d4 challenge.
TACTICAL WARNING	Watch ...d5 tactics and attacks on the e4 pawn before beginning a kingside maneuver.
TRADE FILTER	Trade centrally when it reduces Black's activity or gives White useful files, not merely to avoid tension.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Forecast which structure, majority, target, or superior piece remains after simplification.
CLOCK RULE	Pause at Black's ...d5 or White's e5; otherwise develop without spending several minutes.

ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Against the Sicilian, the KIA is flexible counterplay-not an automatic kingside attack.

13. KIA against the Sicilian - Stage 3



KIA VS SICILIAN

READ THE POSITION

White is castled while Black retains several central setups.

PRIMARY PLAN

Use e5, c3-d4, or queenside restraint according to Black's ...d6, ...e6, and ...g6 formation.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black wants ...d5 or ...d6 followed by central pressure and active queenside play.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 e6 3. d3 Nc6 4. g3 g6 5. Bg2 Bg7 6. O-O Nge7

MEMORY RULE

Against the Sicilian, the KIA is flexible counterplay-not an automatic kingside attack.

13. Decision Framework

KIA against the Sicilian - Stage 3

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	The e5 break must be calculated because Black may answer with ...d6 and central exchanges.
PIECE JOB	Re1 and Bg2 support e5, while c3 can prepare a later d4 challenge.
TACTICAL WARNING	Watch ...d5 tactics and attacks on the e4 pawn before beginning a kingside maneuver.
TRADE FILTER	Trade centrally when it reduces Black's activity or gives White useful files, not merely to avoid tension.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Forecast which structure, majority, target, or superior piece remains after simplification.
CLOCK RULE	Pause at Black's ...d5 or White's e5; otherwise develop without spending several minutes.

ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Against the Sicilian, the KIA is flexible counterplay-not an automatic kingside attack.

14. KIA against the Sicilian - Stage 4



KIA VS SICILIAN

READ THE POSITION

The rooks and kings are placed, but the central structure is still unresolved.

PRIMARY PLAN

Use e5, c3-d4, or queenside restraint according to Black's ...d6, ...e6, and ...g6 formation.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black wants ...d5 or ...d6 followed by central pressure and active queenside play.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 e6 3. d3 Nc6 4. g3 g6 5. Bg2 Bg7 6. O-O Nge7 7. Re1 O-O

MEMORY RULE

Against the Sicilian, the KIA is flexible counterplay-not an automatic kingside attack.

14. Decision Framework

KIA against the Sicilian - Stage 4

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	The e5 break must be calculated because Black may answer with ...d6 and central exchanges.
PIECE JOB	Re1 and Bg2 support e5, while c3 can prepare a later d4 challenge.
TACTICAL WARNING	Watch ...d5 tactics and attacks on the e4 pawn before beginning a kingside maneuver.
TRADE FILTER	Trade centrally when it reduces Black's activity or gives White useful files, not merely to avoid tension.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Forecast which structure, majority, target, or superior piece remains after simplification.
CLOCK RULE	Pause at Black's ...d5 or White's e5; otherwise develop without spending several minutes.

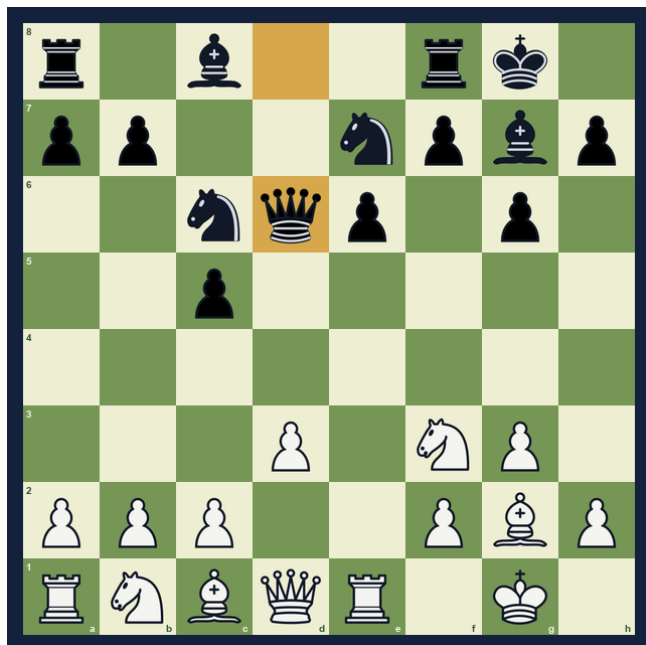
ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Against the Sicilian, the KIA is flexible counterplay-not an automatic kingside attack.

15. KIA against the Sicilian - Stage 5



KIA VS SICILIAN

READ THE POSITION

Central contact has opened the position and removed the possibility of a routine KIA pawn storm.

PRIMARY PLAN

Use e5, c3-d4, or queenside restraint according to Black's ...d6, ...e6, and ...g6 formation.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black wants ...d5 or ...d6 followed by central pressure and active queenside play.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 e6 3. d3 Nc6 4. g3 g6 5. Bg2 Bg7 6. O-O Nge7 7. Re1 O-O 8. e5 d6 9. exd6 Qxd6

MEMORY RULE

Against the Sicilian, the KIA is flexible counterplay-not an automatic kingside attack.

15. Decision Framework

KIA against the Sicilian - Stage 5

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	The e5 break must be calculated because Black may answer with ...d6 and central exchanges.
PIECE JOB	Re1 and Bg2 support e5, while c3 can prepare a later d4 challenge.
TACTICAL WARNING	Watch ...d5 tactics and attacks on the e4 pawn before beginning a kingside maneuver.
TRADE FILTER	Trade centrally when it reduces Black's activity or gives White useful files, not merely to avoid tension.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Forecast which structure, majority, target, or superior piece remains after simplification.
CLOCK RULE	Pause at Black's ...d5 or White's e5; otherwise develop without spending several minutes.

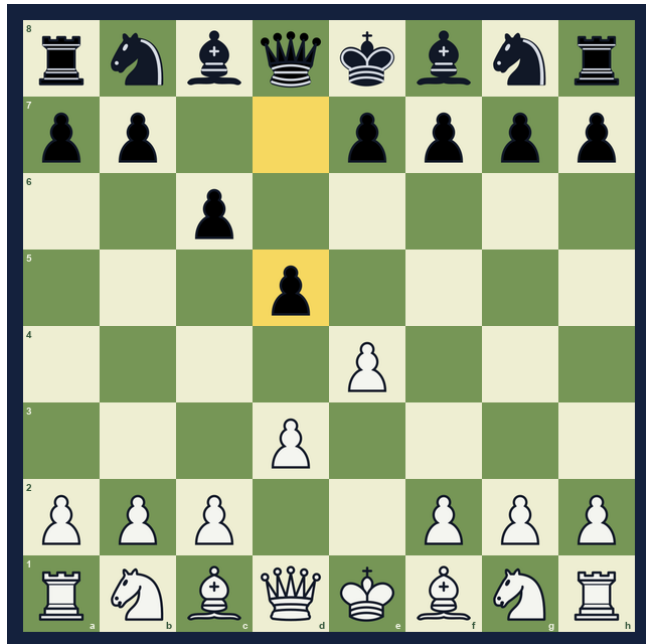
ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Against the Sicilian, the KIA is flexible counterplay-not an automatic kingside attack.

16. KIA against the Caro-Kann - Stage 1



KIA VS CARO-KANN

READ THE POSITION

White has chosen a restrained KIA structure against ...c6 and ...d5.

PRIMARY PLAN

Pressure the center, finish development, and avoid pretending that the usual closed French attack must exist.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black wants comfortable space, ...Nbd7, and piece activity behind the broad center.

REFERENCE LINE 1. e4 c6 2. d3 d5

MEMORY RULE

Against the Caro center, challenge the middle before searching for a wing attack.

16. Decision Framework

KIA against the Caro-Kann - Stage 1

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Use c3-d4 or exd5 when it improves piece activity; e5 may simply concede central squares here.
PIECE JOB	Re1, c3, and the g2-bishop prepare central contact and protect e4.
TACTICAL WARNING	Watch ...dxe4 and ...d4 ideas before moving pieces away from central defense.
TRADE FILTER	Trade central pawns when it prevents Black from maintaining effortless space.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Forecast which structure, majority, target, or superior piece remains after simplification.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on the first central break, not on repeating familiar KIA maneuvers by habit.

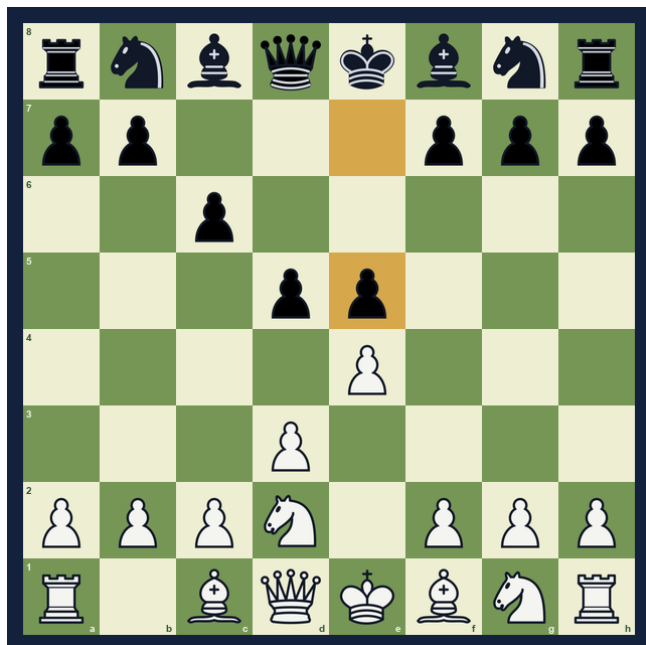
ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Against the Caro center, challenge the middle before searching for a wing attack.

17. KIA against the Caro-Kann - Stage 2



KIA VS CARO-KANN

READ THE POSITION

Black has occupied the center with pawns on d5 and e5.

PRIMARY PLAN

Pressure the center, finish development, and avoid pretending that the usual closed French attack must exist.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black wants comfortable space, ...Nbd7, and piece activity behind the broad center.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 c6 2. d3 d5 3. Nd2 e5

MEMORY RULE

Against the Caro center, challenge the middle before searching for a wing attack.

17. Decision Framework

KIA against the Caro-Kann - Stage 2

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Use c3-d4 or exd5 when it improves piece activity; e5 may simply concede central squares here.
PIECE JOB	Re1, c3, and the g2-bishop prepare central contact and protect e4.
TACTICAL WARNING	Watch ...dxe4 and ...d4 ideas before moving pieces away from central defense.
TRADE FILTER	Trade central pawns when it prevents Black from maintaining effortless space.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Forecast which structure, majority, target, or superior piece remains after simplification.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on the first central break, not on repeating familiar KIA maneuvers by habit.

ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Against the Caro center, challenge the middle before searching for a wing attack.

18. KIA against the Caro-Kann - Stage 3



KIA VS CARO-KANN

READ THE POSITION

Black's center is supported by normal development, so White must not drift.

PRIMARY PLAN

Pressure the center, finish development, and avoid pretending that the usual closed French attack must exist.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black wants comfortable space, ...Nbd7, and piece activity behind the broad center.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 c6 2. d3 d5 3. Nd2 e5 4. Ngf3 Bd6 5. g3 Nf6

MEMORY RULE

Against the Caro center, challenge the middle before searching for a wing attack.

18. Decision Framework

KIA against the Caro-Kann - Stage 3

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Use c3-d4 or exd5 when it improves piece activity; e5 may simply concede central squares here.
PIECE JOB	Re1, c3, and the g2-bishop prepare central contact and protect e4.
TACTICAL WARNING	Watch ...dxe4 and ...d4 ideas before moving pieces away from central defense.
TRADE FILTER	Trade central pawns when it prevents Black from maintaining effortless space.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Forecast which structure, majority, target, or superior piece remains after simplification.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on the first central break, not on repeating familiar KIA maneuvers by habit.

ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Against the Caro center, challenge the middle before searching for a wing attack.

19. KIA against the Caro-Kann - Stage 4



KIA VS CARO-KANN

READ THE POSITION

Both kings are safe and the position is a central maneuvering battle.

PRIMARY PLAN

Pressure the center, finish development, and avoid pretending that the usual closed French attack must exist.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black wants comfortable space, ...Nbd7, and piece activity behind the broad center.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 c6 2. d3 d5 3. Nd2 e5 4. Ng3 Bd6 5. g3 Nf6 6. Bg2 O-O 7. O-O Re8

MEMORY RULE

Against the Caro center, challenge the middle before searching for a wing attack.

19. Decision Framework

KIA against the Caro-Kann - Stage 4

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Use c3-d4 or exd5 when it improves piece activity; e5 may simply concede central squares here.
PIECE JOB	Re1, c3, and the g2-bishop prepare central contact and protect e4.
TACTICAL WARNING	Watch ...dxe4 and ...d4 ideas before moving pieces away from central defense.
TRADE FILTER	Trade central pawns when it prevents Black from maintaining effortless space.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Forecast which structure, majority, target, or superior piece remains after simplification.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on the first central break, not on repeating familiar KIA maneuvers by habit.

ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Against the Caro center, challenge the middle before searching for a wing attack.

20. KIA against the Caro-Kann - Stage 5



KIA VS CARO-KANN

READ THE POSITION

White has prepared central and queenside choices with c3 rather than forcing e5.

PRIMARY PLAN

Pressure the center, finish development, and avoid pretending that the usual closed French attack must exist.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black wants comfortable space, ...Nbd7, and piece activity behind the broad center.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 c6 2. d3 d5 3. Nd2 e5 4. Ngf3 Bd6 5. g3 Nf6 6. Bg2 O-O 7. O-O Re8 8. Re1 Nbd7 9. c3 b6

MEMORY RULE

Against the Caro center, challenge the middle before searching for a wing attack.

20. Decision Framework

KIA against the Caro-Kann - Stage 5

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Use c3-d4 or exd5 when it improves piece activity; e5 may simply concede central squares here.
PIECE JOB	Re1, c3, and the g2-bishop prepare central contact and protect e4.
TACTICAL WARNING	Watch ...dxe4 and ...d4 ideas before moving pieces away from central defense.
TRADE FILTER	Trade central pawns when it prevents Black from maintaining effortless space.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Forecast which structure, majority, target, or superior piece remains after simplification.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on the first central break, not on repeating familiar KIA maneuvers by habit.

ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Against the Caro center, challenge the middle before searching for a wing attack.

21. Closed-Center Kingside Attack - Stage 1



KIA ATTACKING PLAY

READ THE POSITION

White has closed the center and created a clear kingside direction.

PRIMARY PLAN

Bring pieces toward the king, create a useful h-pawn contact, and compare the speed of both attacks.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black wants ...b5-b4, queenside files, and the freeing ...f6 break against e5.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e6 2. d3 d5 3. Nd2 Nf6 4. Ngf3 Be7 5. g3 O-O 6. Bg2 c5 7. O-O Nc6 8. Re1 a6 9. e5 Nd7

MEMORY RULE

Closed center gives direction, but supporting pieces give the attack permission.

21. Decision Framework

Closed-Center Kingside Attack - Stage 1

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Use h4-h5 when it opens lines or fixes weaknesses; prepare f4 only if the center and king permit it.
PIECE JOB	Nf1-h2-g4, Bf4, Qe2, and the g2-bishop form the attacking network.
TACTICAL WARNING	A beautiful formation is not a tactic; calculate ...f6, queenside checks, and sacrifices around e5.
TRADE FILTER	Preserve attackers unless a trade removes Black's key defender or wins the central battle.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Forecast which structure, majority, target, or superior piece remains after simplification.
CLOCK RULE	Count forcing moves on both wings; do not calculate decorative pawn pushes.

ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Closed center gives direction, but supporting pieces give the attack permission.

22. Closed-Center Kingside Attack - Stage 2



KIA ATTACKING PLAY

READ THE POSITION

White begins h-pawn expansion while Black starts queenside play.

PRIMARY PLAN

Bring pieces toward the king, create a useful h-pawn contact, and compare the speed of both attacks.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black wants ...b5-b4, queenside files, and the freeing ...f6 break against e5.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e6 2. d3 d5 3. Nd2 Nf6 4. Ngf3 Be7 5. g3 O-O 6. Bg2 c5 7. O-O Nc6 8. Re1 a6 9. e5 Nd7 10. Nf1 b5 11. h4 a5

MEMORY RULE

Closed center gives direction, but supporting pieces give the attack permission.

22. Decision Framework

Closed-Center Kingside Attack - Stage 2

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Use h4-h5 when it opens lines or fixes weaknesses; prepare f4 only if the center and king permit it.
PIECE JOB	Nf1-h2-g4, Bf4, Qe2, and the g2-bishop form the attacking network.
TACTICAL WARNING	A beautiful formation is not a tactic; calculate ...f6, queenside checks, and sacrifices around e5.
TRADE FILTER	Preserve attackers unless a trade removes Black's key defender or wins the central battle.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Forecast which structure, majority, target, or superior piece remains after simplification.
CLOCK RULE	Count forcing moves on both wings; do not calculate decorative pawn pushes.

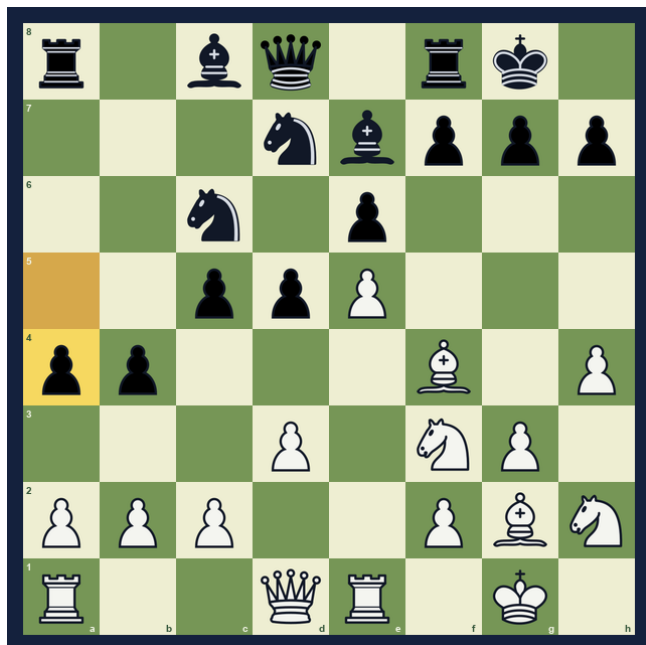
ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Closed center gives direction, but supporting pieces give the attack permission.

23. Closed-Center Kingside Attack - Stage 3



KIA ATTACKING PLAY

READ THE POSITION

White's bishop and knight are moving toward attacking squares as Black gains queenside space.

PRIMARY PLAN

Bring pieces toward the king, create a useful h-pawn contact, and compare the speed of both attacks.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black wants ...b5-b4, queenside files, and the freeing ...f6 break against e5.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e6 2. d3 d5 3. Nd2 Nf6 4. Ngf3 Be7 5. g3 O-O 6. Bg2 c5 7. O-O Nc6 8. Re1 a6 9. e5 Nd7 10. Nf1 b5 11. h4 a5 12. Bf4 b4 13. N1h2 a4

MEMORY RULE

Closed center gives direction, but supporting pieces give the attack permission.

23. Decision Framework

Closed-Center Kingside Attack - Stage 3

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Use h4-h5 when it opens lines or fixes weaknesses; prepare f4 only if the center and king permit it.
PIECE JOB	Nf1-h2-g4, Bf4, Qe2, and the g2-bishop form the attacking network.
TACTICAL WARNING	A beautiful formation is not a tactic; calculate ...f6, queenside checks, and sacrifices around e5.
TRADE FILTER	Preserve attackers unless a trade removes Black's key defender or wins the central battle.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Forecast which structure, majority, target, or superior piece remains after simplification.
CLOCK RULE	Count forcing moves on both wings; do not calculate decorative pawn pushes.

ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Closed center gives direction, but supporting pieces give the attack permission.

24. Closed-Center Kingside Attack - Stage 4



KIA ATTACKING PLAY

READ THE POSITION

The h2-knight has reached g4 and can join pressure near Black's king.

PRIMARY PLAN

Bring pieces toward the king, create a useful h-pawn contact, and compare the speed of both attacks.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black wants ...b5-b4, queenside files, and the freeing ...f6 break against e5.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e6 2. d3 d5 3. Nd2 Nf6 4. Ngf3 Be7 5. g3 O-O 6. Bg2 c5 7. O-O Nc6 8. Re1 a6 9. e5 Nd7 10. Nf1 b5 11. h4 a5 12. Bf4 b4 13. N1h2 a4 14. Ng4 Bb7

MEMORY RULE

Closed center gives direction, but supporting pieces give the attack permission.

24. Decision Framework

Closed-Center Kingside Attack - Stage 4

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Use h4-h5 when it opens lines or fixes weaknesses; prepare f4 only if the center and king permit it.
PIECE JOB	Nf1-h2-g4, Bf4, Qe2, and the g2-bishop form the attacking network.
TACTICAL WARNING	A beautiful formation is not a tactic; calculate ...f6, queenside checks, and sacrifices around e5.
TRADE FILTER	Preserve attackers unless a trade removes Black's key defender or wins the central battle.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Forecast which structure, majority, target, or superior piece remains after simplification.
CLOCK RULE	Count forcing moves on both wings; do not calculate decorative pawn pushes.

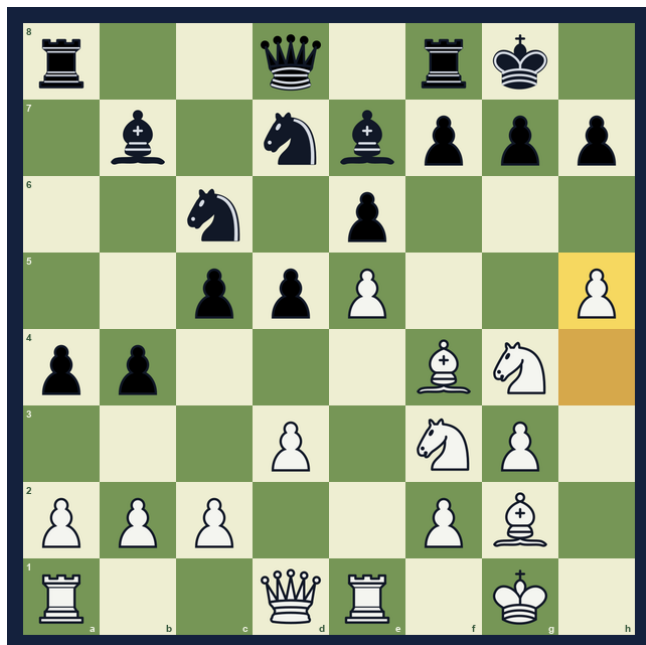
ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Closed center gives direction, but supporting pieces give the attack permission.

25. Closed-Center Kingside Attack - Stage 5



KIA ATTACKING PLAY

READ THE POSITION

White has gained h5 space, but the attack must still be supported by pieces.

PRIMARY PLAN

Bring pieces toward the king, create a useful h-pawn contact, and compare the speed of both attacks.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black wants ...b5-b4, queenside files, and the freeing ...f6 break against e5.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e6 2. d3 d5 3. Nd2 Nf6 4. Ngf3 Be7 5. g3 O-O 6. Bg2 c5 7. O-O Nc6 8. Re1 a6 9. e5 Nd7 10. Nf1 b5 11. h4 a5 12. Bf4 b4 13. N1h2 a4 14. Ng4 Bb7 15. h5

MEMORY RULE

Closed center gives direction, but supporting pieces give the attack permission.

25. Decision Framework

Closed-Center Kingside Attack - Stage 5

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Use h4-h5 when it opens lines or fixes weaknesses; prepare f4 only if the center and king permit it.
PIECE JOB	Nf1-h2-g4, Bf4, Qe2, and the g2-bishop form the attacking network.
TACTICAL WARNING	A beautiful formation is not a tactic; calculate ...f6, queenside checks, and sacrifices around e5.
TRADE FILTER	Preserve attackers unless a trade removes Black's key defender or wins the central battle.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Forecast which structure, majority, target, or superior piece remains after simplification.
CLOCK RULE	Count forcing moves on both wings; do not calculate decorative pawn pushes.

ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Closed center gives direction, but supporting pieces give the attack permission.

26. Meeting Black's ...c5 and ...d4 - Stage 1



KIA CENTRAL COUNTERPLAY

READ THE POSITION

Black has played ...c5 before White commits to a central break.

PRIMARY PLAN

Decide between e5, c3, exd5, or direct pressure before Black fixes a space advantage.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black wants ...d4, ...Nc6, and queenside development with tempo against White's compact center.

REFERENCE LINE

1. Nf3 d5 2. g3 Nf6 3. Bg2 e6 4. O-O Be7 5. d3 O-O 6. Nbd2 c5

MEMORY RULE

If Black can close the center on favorable terms, White's setup has become too slow.

26. Decision Framework

Meeting Black's ...c5 and ...d4 - Stage 1

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Use e5 to close only when the resulting pawn chain favors White; use c3 to restrain ...d4.
PIECE JOB	The d2-knight, Re1, and c-pawn are central defenders before they become attacking pieces.
TACTICAL WARNING	Watch ...d4 forks, attacks on e4, and discovered pressure from the g7 or b7 bishop.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange central pawns when Black's space would otherwise become permanent and effortless.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Forecast which structure, majority, target, or superior piece remains after simplification.
CLOCK RULE	Pause before Black's ...d4; calculate its immediate effects instead of continuing a wing plan automatically.

ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: If Black can close the center on favorable terms, White's setup has become too slow.

27. Meeting Black's ...c5 and ...d4 - Stage 2



KIA CENTRAL COUNTERPLAY

READ THE POSITION

White's e4 center now faces pressure from ...c5 and ...Nc6.

PRIMARY PLAN

Decide between e5, c3, exd5, or direct pressure before Black fixes a space advantage.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black wants ...d4, ...Nc6, and queenside development with tempo against White's compact center.

REFERENCE LINE

1. Nf3 d5 2. g3 Nf6 3. Bg2 e6 4. O-O Be7 5. d3 O-O 6. Nbd2 c5 7. e4 Nc6

MEMORY RULE

If Black can close the center on favorable terms, White's setup has become too slow.

27. Decision Framework

Meeting Black's ...c5 and ...d4 - Stage 2

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Use e5 to close only when the resulting pawn chain favors White; use c3 to restrain ...d4.
PIECE JOB	The d2-knight, Re1, and c-pawn are central defenders before they become attacking pieces.
TACTICAL WARNING	Watch ...d4 forks, attacks on e4, and discovered pressure from the g7 or b7 bishop.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange central pawns when Black's space would otherwise become permanent and effortless.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Forecast which structure, majority, target, or superior piece remains after simplification.
CLOCK RULE	Pause before Black's ...d4; calculate its immediate effects instead of continuing a wing plan automatically.

ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: If Black can close the center on favorable terms, White's setup has become too slow.

28. Meeting Black's ...c5 and ...d4 - Stage 3



KIA CENTRAL COUNTERPLAY

READ THE POSITION

Re1 supports e4 while Black prepares further central expansion.

PRIMARY PLAN

Decide between e5, c3, exd5, or direct pressure before Black fixes a space advantage.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black wants ...d4, ...Nc6, and queenside development with tempo against White's compact center.

REFERENCE LINE

1. Nf3 d5 2. g3 Nf6 3. Bg2 e6 4. O-O Be7 5. d3 O-O 6. Nbd2 c5 7. e4 Nc6 8. Re1 b6

MEMORY RULE

If Black can close the center on favorable terms, White's setup has become too slow.

28. Decision Framework

Meeting Black's ...c5 and ...d4 - Stage 3

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Use e5 to close only when the resulting pawn chain favors White; use c3 to restrain ...d4.
PIECE JOB	The d2-knight, Re1, and c-pawn are central defenders before they become attacking pieces.
TACTICAL WARNING	Watch ...d4 forks, attacks on e4, and discovered pressure from the g7 or b7 bishop.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange central pawns when Black's space would otherwise become permanent and effortless.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Forecast which structure, majority, target, or superior piece remains after simplification.
CLOCK RULE	Pause before Black's ...d4; calculate its immediate effects instead of continuing a wing plan automatically.

ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: If Black can close the center on favorable terms, White's setup has become too slow.

29. Meeting Black's ...c5 and ...d4 - Stage 4



KIA CENTRAL COUNTERPLAY

READ THE POSITION

White has closed with e5, and both sides are reorganizing around the pawn chain.

PRIMARY PLAN

Decide between e5, c3, exd5, or direct pressure before Black fixes a space advantage.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black wants ...d4, ...Nc6, and queenside development with tempo against White's compact center.

REFERENCE LINE

1. Nf3 d5 2. g3 Nf6 3. Bg2 e6 4. O-O Be7 5. d3 O-O 6. Nbd2 c5 7. e4 Nc6 8. Re1 b6 9. e5 Nd7 10. Nf1 Bb7

MEMORY RULE

If Black can close the center on favorable terms, White's setup has become too slow.

29. Decision Framework

Meeting Black's ...c5 and ...d4 - Stage 4

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Use e5 to close only when the resulting pawn chain favors White; use c3 to restrain ...d4.
PIECE JOB	The d2-knight, Re1, and c-pawn are central defenders before they become attacking pieces.
TACTICAL WARNING	Watch ...d4 forks, attacks on e4, and discovered pressure from the g7 or b7 bishop.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange central pawns when Black's space would otherwise become permanent and effortless.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Forecast which structure, majority, target, or superior piece remains after simplification.
CLOCK RULE	Pause before Black's ...d4; calculate its immediate effects instead of continuing a wing plan automatically.

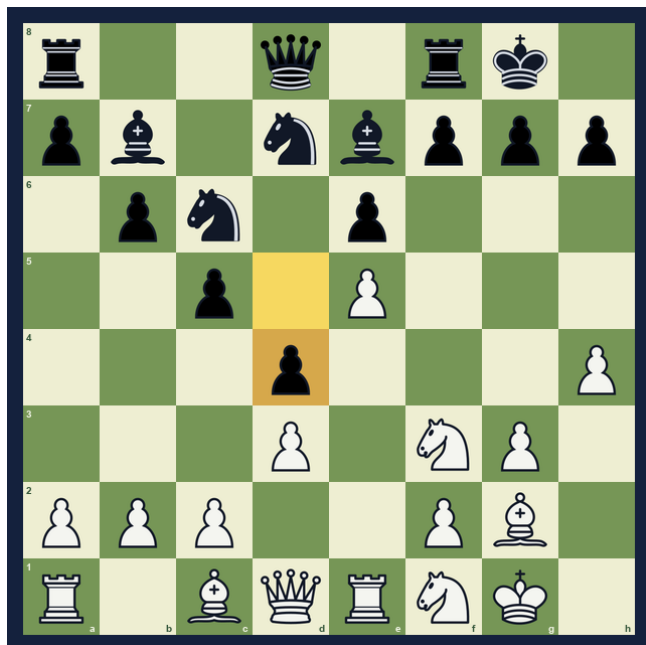
ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: If Black can close the center on favorable terms, White's setup has become too slow.

30. Meeting Black's ...c5 and ...d4 - Stage 5



KIA CENTRAL COUNTERPLAY

READ THE POSITION

Black has advanced ...d4 and gained central space during White's wing preparation.

PRIMARY PLAN

Decide between e5, c3, exd5, or direct pressure before Black fixes a space advantage.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black wants ...d4, ...Nc6, and queenside development with tempo against White's compact center.

REFERENCE LINE

1. Nf3 d5 2. g3 Nf6 3. Bg2 e6 4. O-O Be7 5. d3 O-O 6. Nbd2 c5 7. e4 Nc6 8. Re1 b6 9. e5 Nd7 10. Nf1 Bb7 11. h4 d4

MEMORY RULE

If Black can close the center on favorable terms, White's setup has become too slow.

30. Decision Framework

Meeting Black's ...c5 and ...d4 - Stage 5

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Use e5 to close only when the resulting pawn chain favors White; use c3 to restrain ...d4.
PIECE JOB	The d2-knight, Re1, and c-pawn are central defenders before they become attacking pieces.
TACTICAL WARNING	Watch ...d4 forks, attacks on e4, and discovered pressure from the g7 or b7 bishop.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange central pawns when Black's space would otherwise become permanent and effortless.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Forecast which structure, majority, target, or superior piece remains after simplification.
CLOCK RULE	Pause before Black's ...d4; calculate its immediate effects instead of continuing a wing plan automatically.

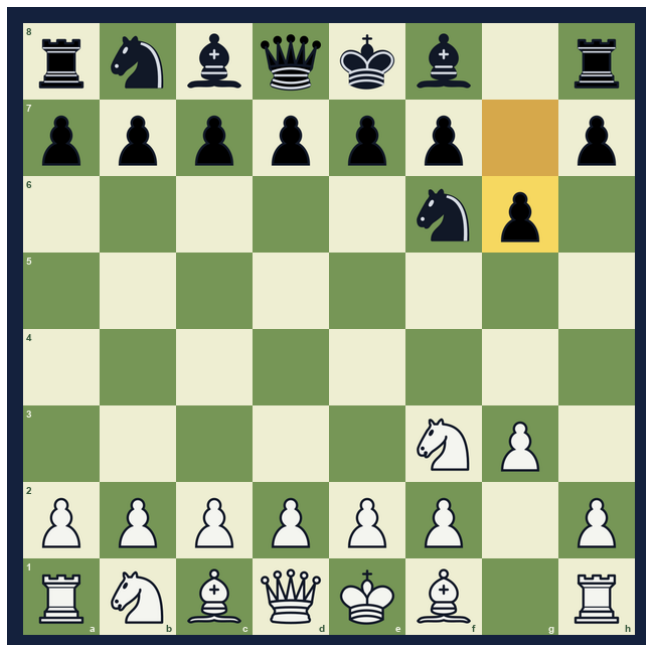
ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: If Black can close the center on favorable terms, White's setup has become too slow.

31. Symmetrical Fianchetto - Stage 1



KIA STRUCTURES

READ THE POSITION

Both sides have begun with the same knight and fianchetto structure.

PRIMARY PLAN

Choose c3-d4, e4-e5, or queenside development according to Black's pawn placement.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black wants equal central space and may use ...d5, ...c6, or kingside restraint.

REFERENCE LINE

1. Nf3 Nf6 2. g3 g6

MEMORY RULE

Against symmetry, create a useful central difference before creating a wing weakness.

31. Decision Framework

Symmetrical Fianchetto - Stage 1

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Break symmetry only when the pawn move improves White's pieces rather than creating a target.
PIECE JOB	Re1, c3, and Nbd2 coordinate the central expansion while Bg2 guards the king.
TACTICAL WARNING	Do not launch h-pawns against a secure king while Black controls the center equally well.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange pieces only if the resulting structure gives White a better minor piece or freer center.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Forecast which structure, majority, target, or superior piece remains after simplification.
CLOCK RULE	Use ordinary development speed until a central break or irreversible pawn move appears.

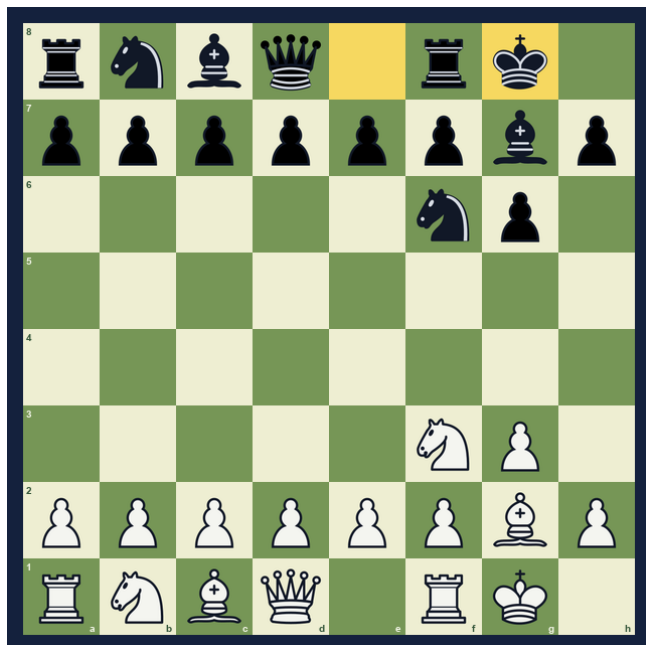
ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Against symmetry, create a useful central difference before creating a wing weakness.

32. Symmetrical Fianchetto - Stage 2



KIA STRUCTURES

READ THE POSITION

The kings are safe and neither side has yet defined the center.

PRIMARY PLAN

Choose c3-d4, e4-e5, or queenside development according to Black's pawn placement.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black wants equal central space and may use ...d5, ...c6, or kingside restraint.

REFERENCE LINE

1. Nf3 Nf6 2. g3 g6 3. Bg2 Bg7 4. O-O O-O

MEMORY RULE

Against symmetry, create a useful central difference before creating a wing weakness.

32. Decision Framework

Symmetrical Fianchetto - Stage 2

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Break symmetry only when the pawn move improves White's pieces rather than creating a target.
PIECE JOB	Re1, c3, and Nbd2 coordinate the central expansion while Bg2 guards the king.
TACTICAL WARNING	Do not launch h-pawns against a secure king while Black controls the center equally well.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange pieces only if the resulting structure gives White a better minor piece or freer center.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Forecast which structure, majority, target, or superior piece remains after simplification.
CLOCK RULE	Use ordinary development speed until a central break or irreversible pawn move appears.

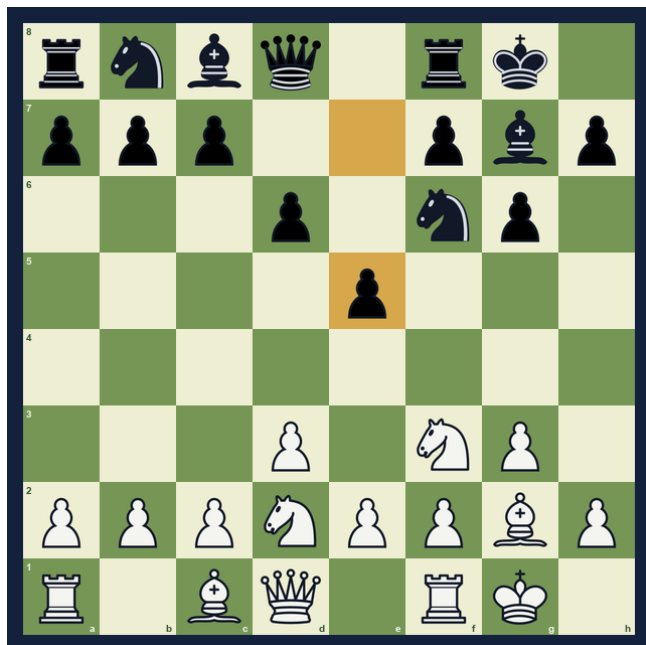
ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Against symmetry, create a useful central difference before creating a wing weakness.

33. Symmetrical Fianchetto - Stage 3



KIA STRUCTURES

READ THE POSITION

Black has claimed e5 while White retains several central choices.

PRIMARY PLAN

Choose c3-d4, e4-e5, or queenside development according to Black's pawn placement.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black wants equal central space and may use ...d5, ...c6, or kingside restraint.

REFERENCE LINE

1. Nf3 Nf6 2. g3 g6 3. Bg2 Bg7 4. O-O O-O 5. d3 d6 6. Nbd2 e5

MEMORY RULE

Against symmetry, create a useful central difference before creating a wing weakness.

33. Decision Framework

Symmetrical Fianchetto - Stage 3

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Break symmetry only when the pawn move improves White's pieces rather than creating a target.
PIECE JOB	Re1, c3, and Nbd2 coordinate the central expansion while Bg2 guards the king.
TACTICAL WARNING	Do not launch h-pawns against a secure king while Black controls the center equally well.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange pieces only if the resulting structure gives White a better minor piece or freer center.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Forecast which structure, majority, target, or superior piece remains after simplification.
CLOCK RULE	Use ordinary development speed until a central break or irreversible pawn move appears.

ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Against symmetry, create a useful central difference before creating a wing weakness.

34. Symmetrical Fianchetto - Stage 4



KIA STRUCTURES

READ THE POSITION

White has matched the center with e4, creating a balanced closed structure.

PRIMARY PLAN

Choose c3-d4, e4-e5, or queenside development according to Black's pawn placement.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black wants equal central space and may use ...d5, ...c6, or kingside restraint.

REFERENCE LINE

1. Nf3 Nf6 2. g3 g6 3. Bg2 Bg7 4. O-O O-O 5. d3 d6 6. Nbd2 e5 7. e4 Nc6

MEMORY RULE

Against symmetry, create a useful central difference before creating a wing weakness.

34. Decision Framework

Symmetrical Fianchetto - Stage 4

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Break symmetry only when the pawn move improves White's pieces rather than creating a target.
PIECE JOB	Re1, c3, and Nbd2 coordinate the central expansion while Bg2 guards the king.
TACTICAL WARNING	Do not launch h-pawns against a secure king while Black controls the center equally well.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange pieces only if the resulting structure gives White a better minor piece or freer center.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Forecast which structure, majority, target, or superior piece remains after simplification.
CLOCK RULE	Use ordinary development speed until a central break or irreversible pawn move appears.

ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Against symmetry, create a useful central difference before creating a wing weakness.

35. Symmetrical Fianchetto - Stage 5



KIA STRUCTURES

READ THE POSITION

White has added c3 and Re1, preparing central expansion or patient maneuvering.

PRIMARY PLAN

Choose c3-d4, e4-e5, or queenside development according to Black's pawn placement.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black wants equal central space and may use ...d5, ...c6, or kingside restraint.

REFERENCE LINE

1. Nf3 Nf6 2. g3 g6 3. Bg2 Bg7 4. O-O O-O 5. d3 d6 6. Nbd2 e5 7. e4 Nc6 8. Re1 h6 9. c3 a5

MEMORY RULE

Against symmetry, create a useful central difference before creating a wing weakness.

35. Decision Framework

Symmetrical Fianchetto - Stage 5

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Break symmetry only when the pawn move improves White's pieces rather than creating a target.
PIECE JOB	Re1, c3, and Nbd2 coordinate the central expansion while Bg2 guards the king.
TACTICAL WARNING	Do not launch h-pawns against a secure king while Black controls the center equally well.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange pieces only if the resulting structure gives White a better minor piece or freer center.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Forecast which structure, majority, target, or superior piece remains after simplification.
CLOCK RULE	Use ordinary development speed until a central break or irreversible pawn move appears.

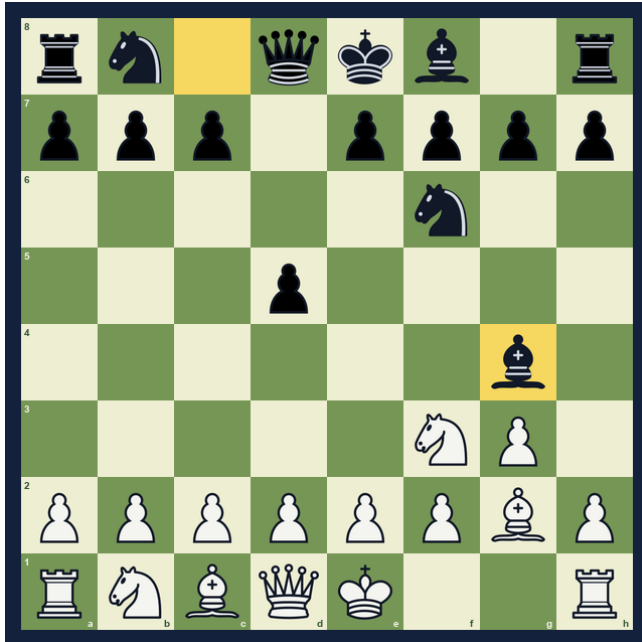
ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Against symmetry, create a useful central difference before creating a wing weakness.

36. Active Black Bishops - Stage 1



KIA MOVE ORDERS

READ THE POSITION

Black has developed ...Bg4 before White completes the KIA setup.

PRIMARY PLAN

Develop, challenge the bishop only when useful, and keep the central plan more important than gaining a bishop pair.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black wants easy development and may use the bishop to slow e4 or provoke weakening pawn moves.

REFERENCE LINE

1. Nf3 d5 2. g3 Nf6 3. Bg2 Bg4

MEMORY RULE

An active bishop changes move order and tactics-not White's obligation to fight the center.

36. Decision Framework

Active Black Bishops - Stage 1

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Use e4, c4, or h3 only when the resulting center justifies the tempo and pawn weakness.
PIECE JOB	The queen, knight, and e-pawn must account for pins before White executes a central break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Chasing the bishop with h3-g4 can weaken the king and lose time if the center opens.
TRADE FILTER	Trade the active bishop when it improves White's center; do not spend several tempi forcing it.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Forecast which structure, majority, target, or superior piece remains after simplification.
CLOCK RULE	Pause for the pin, verify central tactics, then continue development without overreacting.

ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: An active bishop changes move order and tactics-not White's obligation to fight the center.

37. Active Black Bishops - Stage 2



KIA MOVE ORDERS

READ THE POSITION

The active bishop creates a pin and influences White's central preparation.

PRIMARY PLAN

Develop, challenge the bishop only when useful, and keep the central plan more important than gaining a bishop pair.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black wants easy development and may use the bishop to slow e4 or provoke weakening pawn moves.

REFERENCE LINE

1. Nf3 d5 2. g3 Nf6 3. Bg2 Bg4 4. O-O Nbd7

MEMORY RULE

An active bishop changes move order and tactics-not White's obligation to fight the center.

37. Decision Framework

Active Black Bishops - Stage 2

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Use e4, c4, or h3 only when the resulting center justifies the tempo and pawn weakness.
PIECE JOB	The queen, knight, and e-pawn must account for pins before White executes a central break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Chasing the bishop with h3-g4 can weaken the king and lose time if the center opens.
TRADE FILTER	Trade the active bishop when it improves White's center; do not spend several tempi forcing it.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Forecast which structure, majority, target, or superior piece remains after simplification.
CLOCK RULE	Pause for the pin, verify central tactics, then continue development without overreacting.

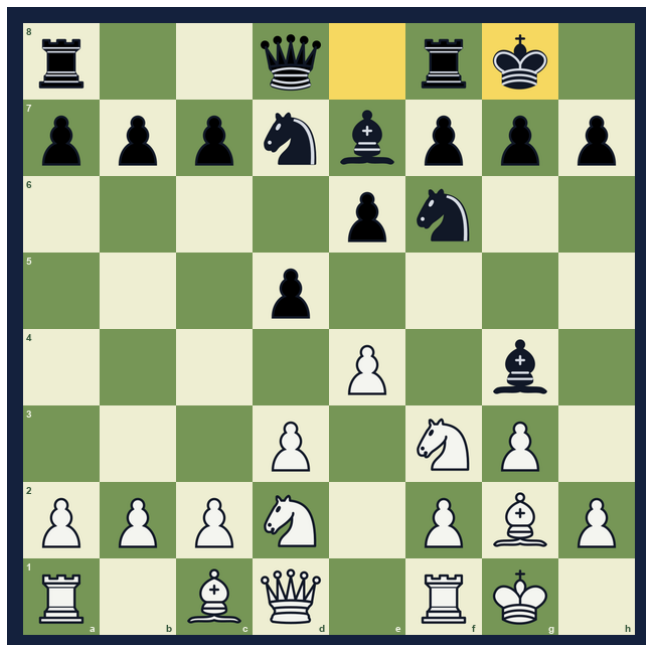
ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: An active bishop changes move order and tactics-not White's obligation to fight the center.

38. Active Black Bishops - Stage 3



KIA MOVE ORDERS

READ THE POSITION

White has built e4 despite the active bishop, so central tactics require attention.

PRIMARY PLAN

Develop, challenge the bishop only when useful, and keep the central plan more important than gaining a bishop pair.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black wants easy development and may use the bishop to slow e4 or provoke weakening pawn moves.

REFERENCE LINE

1. Nf3 d5 2. g3 Nf6 3. Bg2 Bg4 4. O-O Nbd7 5. d3 e6 6. Nbd2 Be7 7. e4 O-O

MEMORY RULE

An active bishop changes move order and tactics-not White's obligation to fight the center.

38. Decision Framework

Active Black Bishops - Stage 3

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Use e4, c4, or h3 only when the resulting center justifies the tempo and pawn weakness.
PIECE JOB	The queen, knight, and e-pawn must account for pins before White executes a central break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Chasing the bishop with h3-g4 can weaken the king and lose time if the center opens.
TRADE FILTER	Trade the active bishop when it improves White's center; do not spend several tempi forcing it.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Forecast which structure, majority, target, or superior piece remains after simplification.
CLOCK RULE	Pause for the pin, verify central tactics, then continue development without overreacting.

ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: An active bishop changes move order and tactics-not White's obligation to fight the center.

39. Active Black Bishops - Stage 4



KIA MOVE ORDERS

READ THE POSITION

Black's bishop has developed to f5 outside the pawn chain.

PRIMARY PLAN

Develop, challenge the bishop only when useful, and keep the central plan more important than gaining a bishop pair.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black wants easy development and may use the bishop to slow e4 or provoke weakening pawn moves.

REFERENCE LINE

1. Nf3 d5 2. g3 Nf6 3. Bg2 c6 4. O-O Bf5

MEMORY RULE

An active bishop changes move order and tactics-not White's obligation to fight the center.

39. Decision Framework

Active Black Bishops - Stage 4

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Use e4, c4, or h3 only when the resulting center justifies the tempo and pawn weakness.
PIECE JOB	The queen, knight, and e-pawn must account for pins before White executes a central break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Chasing the bishop with h3-g4 can weaken the king and lose time if the center opens.
TRADE FILTER	Trade the active bishop when it improves White's center; do not spend several tempi forcing it.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Forecast which structure, majority, target, or superior piece remains after simplification.
CLOCK RULE	Pause for the pin, verify central tactics, then continue development without overreacting.

ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: An active bishop changes move order and tactics-not White's obligation to fight the center.

40. Active Black Bishops - Stage 5



KIA MOVE ORDERS

READ THE POSITION

Both sides are developing, but Black's active bishop changes White's normal maneuvering routes.

PRIMARY PLAN

Develop, challenge the bishop only when useful, and keep the central plan more important than gaining a bishop pair.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black wants easy development and may use the bishop to slow e4 or provoke weakening pawn moves.

REFERENCE LINE

1. Nf3 d5 2. g3 Nf6 3. Bg2 c6 4. O-O Bf5 5. d3 e6 6. Nbd2 Be7

MEMORY RULE

An active bishop changes move order and tactics-not White's obligation to fight the center.

40. Decision Framework

Active Black Bishops - Stage 5

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Use e4, c4, or h3 only when the resulting center justifies the tempo and pawn weakness.
PIECE JOB	The queen, knight, and e-pawn must account for pins before White executes a central break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Chasing the bishop with h3-g4 can weaken the king and lose time if the center opens.
TRADE FILTER	Trade the active bishop when it improves White's center; do not spend several tempi forcing it.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Forecast which structure, majority, target, or superior piece remains after simplification.
CLOCK RULE	Pause for the pin, verify central tactics, then continue development without overreacting.

ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: An active bishop changes move order and tactics-not White's obligation to fight the center.

41. KIA Piece Maneuvers - Stage 1



KIA MIDDLEGAMES

READ THE POSITION

White has reached the point where piece routes must serve a central plan.

PRIMARY PLAN

Place every piece according to the intended break, attacking square, or defensive responsibility.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black wants queenside space, ...f6 against e5, and exchanges that reduce White's attackers.

REFERENCE LINE

1. Nf3 d5 2. g3 Nf6 3. Bg2 e6 4. O-O Be7 5. d3 O-O 6. Nbd2 c5

MEMORY RULE

A KIA maneuver is correct only when you can name the break or square it supports.

41. Decision Framework

KIA Piece Maneuvers - Stage 1

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	The e5 or f4 break should be supported by the pieces before White commits more pawns.
PIECE JOB	Nf1 chooses among e3, h2, and g3; Bf4, Qe2, and Re1 support the central and kingside plan.
TACTICAL WARNING	A memorized knight route fails if Black opens the center or threatens material on the queenside.
TRADE FILTER	Keep the attacking knight and dark bishop unless an exchange wins a key square or removes counterplay.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Forecast which structure, majority, target, or superior piece remains after simplification.
CLOCK RULE	Compare two purposeful piece routes; do not calculate every legal maneuver.

ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: A KIA maneuver is correct only when you can name the break or square it supports.

42. KIA Piece Maneuvers - Stage 2



KIA MIDDLEGAMES

READ THE POSITION

Re1 and the compact center give White a choice between e5 and patient preparation.

PRIMARY PLAN

Place every piece according to the intended break, attacking square, or defensive responsibility.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black wants queenside space, ...f6 against e5, and exchanges that reduce White's attackers.

REFERENCE LINE

1. Nf3 d5 2. g3 Nf6 3. Bg2 e6 4. O-O Be7 5. d3 O-O 6. Nbd2 c5 7. e4 Nc6 8. Re1 b6

MEMORY RULE

A KIA maneuver is correct only when you can name the break or square it supports.

42. Decision Framework

KIA Piece Maneuvers - Stage 2

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	The e5 or f4 break should be supported by the pieces before White commits more pawns.
PIECE JOB	Nf1 chooses among e3, h2, and g3; Bf4, Qe2, and Re1 support the central and kingside plan.
TACTICAL WARNING	A memorized knight route fails if Black opens the center or threatens material on the queenside.
TRADE FILTER	Keep the attacking knight and dark bishop unless an exchange wins a key square or removes counterplay.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Forecast which structure, majority, target, or superior piece remains after simplification.
CLOCK RULE	Compare two purposeful piece routes; do not calculate every legal maneuver.

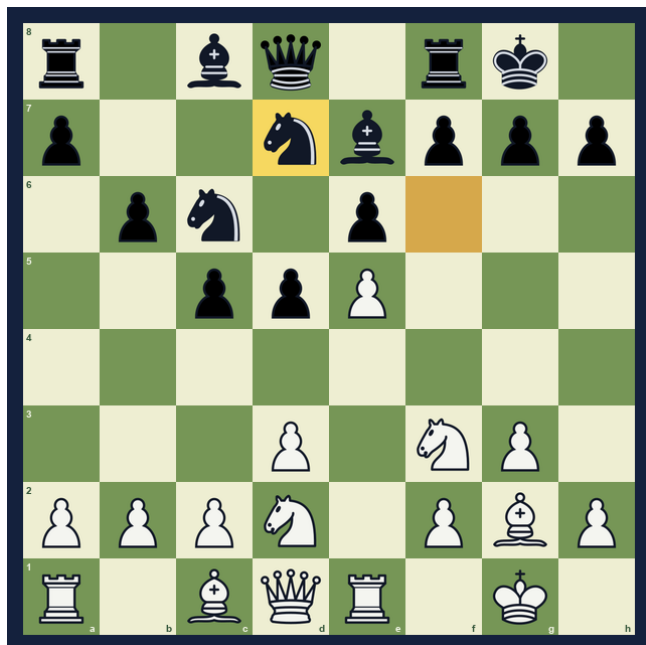
ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: A KIA maneuver is correct only when you can name the break or square it supports.

43. KIA Piece Maneuvers - Stage 3



KIA MIDDLEGAMES

READ THE POSITION

The e5 advance has created a closed-center map for the pieces.

PRIMARY PLAN

Place every piece according to the intended break, attacking square, or defensive responsibility.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black wants queenside space, ...f6 against e5, and exchanges that reduce White's attackers.

REFERENCE LINE

1. Nf3 d5 2. g3 Nf6 3. Bg2 e6 4. O-O Be7 5. d3 O-O 6. Nbd2 c5 7. e4 Nc6 8. Re1 b6 9. e5 Nd7

MEMORY RULE

A KIA maneuver is correct only when you can name the break or square it supports.

43. Decision Framework

KIA Piece Maneuvers - Stage 3

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	The e5 or f4 break should be supported by the pieces before White commits more pawns.
PIECE JOB	Nf1 chooses among e3, h2, and g3; Bf4, Qe2, and Re1 support the central and kingside plan.
TACTICAL WARNING	A memorized knight route fails if Black opens the center or threatens material on the queenside.
TRADE FILTER	Keep the attacking knight and dark bishop unless an exchange wins a key square or removes counterplay.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Forecast which structure, majority, target, or superior piece remains after simplification.
CLOCK RULE	Compare two purposeful piece routes; do not calculate every legal maneuver.

ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: A KIA maneuver is correct only when you can name the break or square it supports.

44. KIA Piece Maneuvers - Stage 4



KIA MIDDLEGAMES

READ THE POSITION

The d2-knight has reached f1, ready for e3, h2, or g3 routes.

PRIMARY PLAN

Place every piece according to the intended break, attacking square, or defensive responsibility.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black wants queenside space, ...f6 against e5, and exchanges that reduce White's attackers.

REFERENCE LINE

1. Nf3 d5 2. g3 Nf6 3. Bg2 e6 4. O-O Be7 5. d3 O-O 6. Nbd2 c5 7. e4 Nc6 8. Re1 b6 9. e5 Nd7 10. Nf1 Bb7

MEMORY RULE

A KIA maneuver is correct only when you can name the break or square it supports.

44. Decision Framework

KIA Piece Maneuvers - Stage 4

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	The e5 or f4 break should be supported by the pieces before White commits more pawns.
PIECE JOB	Nf1 chooses among e3, h2, and g3; Bf4, Qe2, and Re1 support the central and kingside plan.
TACTICAL WARNING	A memorized knight route fails if Black opens the center or threatens material on the queenside.
TRADE FILTER	Keep the attacking knight and dark bishop unless an exchange wins a key square or removes counterplay.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Forecast which structure, majority, target, or superior piece remains after simplification.
CLOCK RULE	Compare two purposeful piece routes; do not calculate every legal maneuver.

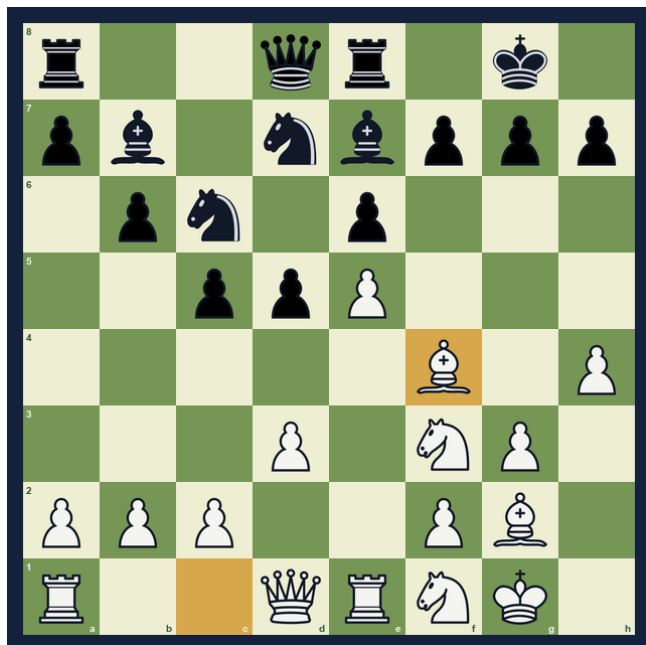
ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: A KIA maneuver is correct only when you can name the break or square it supports.

45. KIA Piece Maneuvers - Stage 5



KIA MIDDLEGAMES

READ THE POSITION

White has coordinated h4 and Bf4 with the closed-center structure.

PRIMARY PLAN

Place every piece according to the intended break, attacking square, or defensive responsibility.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black wants queenside space, ...f6 against e5, and exchanges that reduce White's attackers.

REFERENCE LINE

1. Nf3 d5 2. g3 Nf6 3. Bg2 e6 4. O-O Be7 5. d3 O-O 6. Nbd2 c5 7. e4 Nc6 8. Re1 b6 9. e5 Nd7 10. Nf1 Bb7 11. h4 Re8 12. Bf4

MEMORY RULE

A KIA maneuver is correct only when you can name the break or square it supports.

45. Decision Framework

KIA Piece Maneuvers - Stage 5

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	The e5 or f4 break should be supported by the pieces before White commits more pawns.
PIECE JOB	Nf1 chooses among e3, h2, and g3; Bf4, Qe2, and Re1 support the central and kingside plan.
TACTICAL WARNING	A memorized knight route fails if Black opens the center or threatens material on the queenside.
TRADE FILTER	Keep the attacking knight and dark bishop unless an exchange wins a key square or removes counterplay.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Forecast which structure, majority, target, or superior piece remains after simplification.
CLOCK RULE	Compare two purposeful piece routes; do not calculate every legal maneuver.

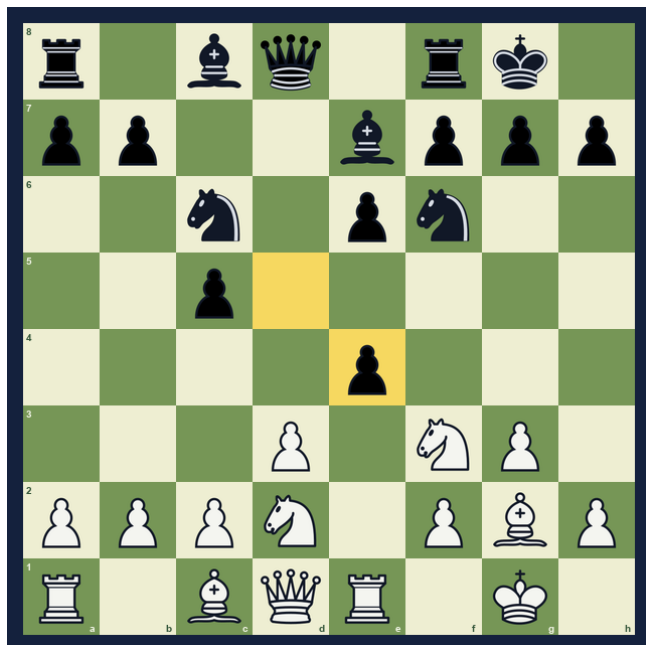
ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: A KIA maneuver is correct only when you can name the break or square it supports.

46. Open Center and Ordinary Chess - Stage 1



KIA OPEN CENTERS

READ THE POSITION

Black has opened the center by capturing e4.

PRIMARY PLAN

Complete development, contest open files, and improve the least active piece without forcing a KIA attack.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black wants active central pieces and may use the open position before White completes development.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e6 2. d3 d5 3. Nd2 Nf6 4. Ngf3 Be7 5. g3 O-O 6. Bg2 c5 7. O-O Nc6 8. Re1 dxe4

MEMORY RULE

When the center opens, stop playing the setup and start playing ordinary chess.

46. Decision Framework

Open Center and Ordinary Chess - Stage 1

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Use c3-d4 or timely exchanges to improve activity; avoid closing moves that concede squares without reason.
PIECE JOB	Rooks, queen, and the c1-bishop become urgent once central files open.
TACTICAL WARNING	Do not play Nf1-h2 or h4 automatically while Black can create central tactics with tempo.
TRADE FILTER	Trade when it improves the remaining minor piece or removes Black's central initiative.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Forecast which structure, majority, target, or superior piece remains after simplification.
CLOCK RULE	Calculate forcing central moves, then return to normal development and positional evaluation.

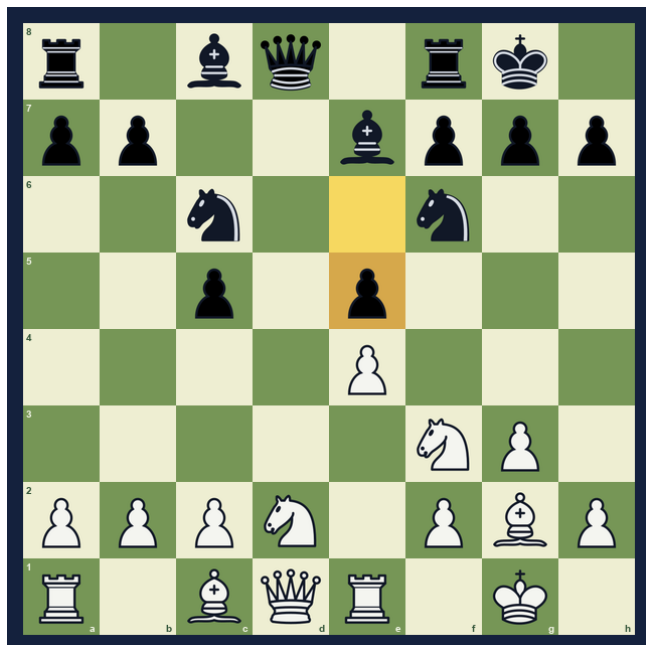
ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: When the center opens, stop playing the setup and start playing ordinary chess.

47. Open Center and Ordinary Chess - Stage 2



KIA OPEN CENTERS

READ THE POSITION

White has restored the pawn while Black claims e5, creating an open strategic battle.

PRIMARY PLAN

Complete development, contest open files, and improve the least active piece without forcing a KIA attack.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black wants active central pieces and may use the open position before White completes development.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e6 2. d3 d5 3. Nd2 Nf6 4. Ng3 Be7 5. g3 O-O 6. Bg2 c5 7. O-O Nc6 8. Re1 dxe4 9. dxe4 e5

MEMORY RULE

When the center opens, stop playing the setup and start playing ordinary chess.

47. Decision Framework

Open Center and Ordinary Chess - Stage 2

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Use c3-d4 or timely exchanges to improve activity; avoid closing moves that concede squares without reason.
PIECE JOB	Rooks, queen, and the c1-bishop become urgent once central files open.
TACTICAL WARNING	Do not play Nf1-h2 or h4 automatically while Black can create central tactics with tempo.
TRADE FILTER	Trade when it improves the remaining minor piece or removes Black's central initiative.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Forecast which structure, majority, target, or superior piece remains after simplification.
CLOCK RULE	Calculate forcing central moves, then return to normal development and positional evaluation.

ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: When the center opens, stop playing the setup and start playing ordinary chess.

48. Open Center and Ordinary Chess - Stage 3



KIA OPEN CENTERS

READ THE POSITION

White uses c3 to support the center rather than beginning a wing attack.

PRIMARY PLAN

Complete development, contest open files, and improve the least active piece without forcing a KIA attack.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black wants active central pieces and may use the open position before White completes development.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e6 2. d3 d5 3. Nd2 Nf6 4. Ngf3 Be7 5. g3 O-O 6. Bg2 c5 7. O-O Nc6 8. Re1 dxe4 9. dxe4 e5 10. c3 Qc7

MEMORY RULE

When the center opens, stop playing the setup and start playing ordinary chess.

48. Decision Framework

Open Center and Ordinary Chess - Stage 3

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Use c3-d4 or timely exchanges to improve activity; avoid closing moves that concede squares without reason.
PIECE JOB	Rooks, queen, and the c1-bishop become urgent once central files open.
TACTICAL WARNING	Do not play Nf1-h2 or h4 automatically while Black can create central tactics with tempo.
TRADE FILTER	Trade when it improves the remaining minor piece or removes Black's central initiative.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Forecast which structure, majority, target, or superior piece remains after simplification.
CLOCK RULE	Calculate forcing central moves, then return to normal development and positional evaluation.

ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: When the center opens, stop playing the setup and start playing ordinary chess.

49. Open Center and Ordinary Chess - Stage 4



KIA OPEN CENTERS

READ THE POSITION

The queens and rooks are moving toward central files in an ordinary middlegame.

PRIMARY PLAN

Complete development, contest open files, and improve the least active piece without forcing a KIA attack.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black wants active central pieces and may use the open position before White completes development.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e6 2. d3 d5 3. Nd2 Nf6 4. Ngf3 Be7 5. g3 O-O 6. Bg2 c5 7. O-O Nc6 8. Re1 dxe4 9. dxe4 e5 10. c3 Qc7 11. Qc2 b6

MEMORY RULE

When the center opens, stop playing the setup and start playing ordinary chess.

49. Decision Framework

Open Center and Ordinary Chess - Stage 4

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Use c3-d4 or timely exchanges to improve activity; avoid closing moves that concede squares without reason.
PIECE JOB	Rooks, queen, and the c1-bishop become urgent once central files open.
TACTICAL WARNING	Do not play Nf1-h2 or h4 automatically while Black can create central tactics with tempo.
TRADE FILTER	Trade when it improves the remaining minor piece or removes Black's central initiative.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Forecast which structure, majority, target, or superior piece remains after simplification.
CLOCK RULE	Calculate forcing central moves, then return to normal development and positional evaluation.

ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: When the center opens, stop playing the setup and start playing ordinary chess.

50. Open Center and Ordinary Chess - Stage 5



KIA OPEN CENTERS

READ THE POSITION

Both sides have developed around the open center, where activity matters more than setup memory.

PRIMARY PLAN

Complete development, contest open files, and improve the least active piece without forcing a KIA attack.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black wants active central pieces and may use the open position before White completes development.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e6 2. d3 d5 3. Nd2 Nf6 4. Ngf3 Be7 5. g3 O-O 6. Bg2 c5 7. O-O Nc6 8. Re1 dxe4 9. dxe4 e5 10. c3 Qc7 11. Qc2 b6 12. b3 Bb7

MEMORY RULE

When the center opens, stop playing the setup and start playing ordinary chess.

50. Decision Framework

Open Center and Ordinary Chess - Stage 5

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Use c3-d4 or timely exchanges to improve activity; avoid closing moves that concede squares without reason.
PIECE JOB	Rooks, queen, and the c1-bishop become urgent once central files open.
TACTICAL WARNING	Do not play Nf1-h2 or h4 automatically while Black can create central tactics with tempo.
TRADE FILTER	Trade when it improves the remaining minor piece or removes Black's central initiative.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Forecast which structure, majority, target, or superior piece remains after simplification.
CLOCK RULE	Calculate forcing central moves, then return to normal development and positional evaluation.

ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: When the center opens, stop playing the setup and start playing ordinary chess.

Course Completion Test

Choose ten chapters at random. Rebuild each reference position, name both sides' plans, identify the critical break, and state the trade filter without reopening the chapter.

Score one point for the structure, one for your plan, one for counterplay, one for the break, and one for the memory rule. Forty out of fifty means the knowledge is usable; below forty means retrieval practice should continue.

FINAL PRINCIPLE

A course is complete when its ideas appear in your decisions, not when its pages have been read.